

TRAGEDY AT WALTHAMSTOW.

Between five and six o'clock last night a man named William Gouldstone, living at St. James's-street, Walthamstow, drowned three of his children, Charles and Herbert, aged $3\frac{1}{2}$ and $2\frac{1}{2}$ years respectively, and Frederick, aged sixteen months, and so seriously assaulted another two—twin infants—unnamed, only seven days old, that one of them has since died, and the death of the second is hourly expected. Gouldstone is 43 years of age, and is employed by a firm in Lower Thames-street, London. A week ago his wife was confined of twins, and a nurse was in the house. Shortly before six o'clock last night Gouldstone returned home, rather earlier than usual. He seemed in a very bad mood, and told the nurse he wanted her out of the house while he had a chat with his wife alone. The nurse went away, but was surprised a short time afterwards at seeing the cistern running over. On opening it she was horrified to discover the dead bodies of three children. At the same moment she heard a screaming in the room where Mrs. Gouldstone was in bed. She knocked for admittance, but being unable to gain entrance she got assistance, and the door was burst in. It was then found that the father, after drowning, as is supposed, his three eldest children, had struck the twin babies at their mother's breast with a hammer. The police were at once sent for, and the man was taken to the Lea Bridge-road police-station. When the nurse asked the prisoner what he was doing he said, "Never mind, I am happy now, and she is a single woman." No motive can be assigned for the outrage. His conduct, it is said, has been rather strange during the last week. He is stated to be a most abstemious man, the wife adding that she had but once seen him the worse for liquor. He has been in his present employ some five or six years.